

John Logie Baird

The man who invented the first TELEVISION, and gave the world something to watch

All about me

- BORN: 1888
- DIED: 1946
- NATIONALITY: Scottish
- FACTOID: I was an engineer and inventor.
- IN A NUTSHELL: As a child, I built a telephone exchange in my bedroom so I could talk with my friends.

By the way...
when I was in my twenties, I tried to make diamonds by heating graphite, but only managed to short out Glasgow's electricity supply.

Baird started selling TVs in 1930, but the spinning disk made them very noisy.



The TV star

Scientists had been **trying to build a television for decades**. Baird's first attempt was quite crude, and was made of odds and ends, but, by 1924, he had managed to **transmit a flickering image** a short distance. In 1926, he demonstrated the **WORLD'S FIRST TELEVISION** to 50 scientists in London.

The mechanical televison

Baird's television wasn't the electronic device we know today, but was more like a **CLOCKWORK MACHINE**. It used a **spinning cardboard disk**, which had a series of square holes stamped into it. As the disk spun, each hole scanned a different part of the image. His TV produced a **tiny, flickering 30-line picture**, where modern TVs produce more than 1,000 lines... not exactly high definition.

